theorem] starts with a summary of the EPR argument *from locality* to deterministic hidden variables. But the commentators have almost universally reported that it begins with deterministic hidden variables."

Another, related claim is that Bell's theorem assumes *realism* of some kind. This is an especially popular claim among supporters of the Copenhagen interpretation. If you don't assume that the quantum world has real properties—or if you don't assume that there's a quantum world at all—then, they claim, Bell's theorem doesn't work. This is also incorrect. The problem here is that phrase "realism of some kind." What, exactly, is meant by "realism"? Some physicists claim that Bell's theorem assumes the idea that quantum objects have well-defined properties before they're measured, and that this is what is meant by "realism." But this is simply not true, as previously stated—there's no assumption of preexisting properties (i.e., hidden variables) in Bell's theorem at all. That idea comes out of the assumption of locality, just as it does in the EPR argument. Others claim that the form of realism assumed by Bell's theorem is the very idea that anything at all exists independently of observation. Denying this, they claim, is the true insight of the Copenhagen interpretation, and this is what allows the Copenhagen interpretation to remain local despite Bell's ingenious proof. Ignoring the problem of solipsism that this introduces into physics—whose observations make things real?—another problem arises. Without the assumption that reality exists independently of observation in some form, the idea of locality itself is meaningless. How can it mean anything to talk about effects moving faster than light from one place to another when neither the objects nor their locations exist at all? Denying realism to break Bell's proof invariably breaks the concept of locality as well—a Pyrrhic victory for the antirealists determined to keep physics local at all costs. As Bell himself said, "I don't know any conception of locality which works with quantum mechanics. So I think we're stuck with nonlocality."

Even quantum physics itself isn't an assumption in Bell's proof. After all, Fatima didn't have to appeal to quantum physics when explaining the impossibility of Ronnie's roulette balls. Bell's theorem is merely a claim about the world, independent of quantum physics. If the world works in a particular way—if Ronnie's roulette balls, or entangled photons, obey the statistics observed at the casino—then either locality is broken or nature